

NorthPeak Website — Setup & Launch Guide

Everything needed to connect the booking calendar and contact form, publish the new site on northpeakfp.com, and retire the Squarespace site safely.

Before You Start: What Must Be Filled In

The site is complete and ready to deploy. One item still needs you (the form endpoint), and one is strongly recommended.

Item	Where it appears	Status
Phone (847) 644-2288	Footer, Contact page, schema	Done
Wilmette, IL	Footer, Contact page, schema	Done
Starter price \$149/month	Services page, FAQ, schema	Done
PASTE_YOUR_FORMS PREE_ENDPOINT	contact.html	Needs you — Part 1 of this guide
Founder name + bio	about.html	Recommended — see note below

Also strongly recommended: add the founder's real name and a short bio to **about.html**. Google's quality guidelines treat financial content as 'Your Money or Your Life' and weigh author identity heavily. An anonymous financial site ranks worse than a named one.

Part 1 — Contact Form Delivery (required)

There is no booking calendar on the site by design. Enquiries come in two ways: the contact form, and the phone number (847) 644-2288 shown in the footer of every page and on the Contact page. The form is the only piece that needs connecting.

A plain HTML form can't send email by itself; it needs a delivery service. The form is already built and validated — it just needs an endpoint. **Formspree** has a free tier and takes about three minutes.

- 1Go to formspree.io and create a free account using **info@northpeakfp.com**.
- 2Click **New Form**, name it 'NorthPeak Website Inquiries'.
- 3Set the notification email to info@northpeakfp.com.
- 4Copy the form endpoint it gives you (it looks like https://formspree.io/f/xxxxxxx).
- 5Open **contact.html**, find **PASTE_YOUR_FORMSPREE_ENDPOINT_HERE** — it appears twice, in **data-endpoint** and **action**. Replace both with the endpoint.
- 6Save, then submit a test message and confirm it arrives.

Built-in safety net: if the endpoint is left unset, the form automatically falls back to opening the visitor's email app addressed to `info@northpeakfp.com`. Nothing silently disappears. A hidden anti-spam honeypot field is already included.

Free alternatives: **Web3Forms**, **FormSubmit**, or **Netlify Forms** (free and automatic if you host on Netlify — see Part 3).

Part 2 — Publishing the Site

The site is plain HTML/CSS/JS, so it runs anywhere. Two recommended options:

Option A — Netlify (recommended: free, fastest, includes forms)

- 1 Create a free account at netlify.com.
- 2 Choose **Add new site** → **Deploy manually**.
- 3 Drag the entire **northpeak-site** folder onto the upload area. It deploys in seconds and gives you a temporary address like **random-name.netlify.app**.
- 4 Test everything on that temporary address *before* pointing the real domain at it.
- 5 When satisfied, go to **Domain settings** → **Add custom domain** and enter **northpeakfp.com**.
- 6 Netlify will show the DNS records to set. Do NOT change DNS yet — finish reading Part 3 first.

Option B — Cloudflare Pages / GitHub Pages

Both are free and work identically for a static site. Cloudflare Pages accepts a direct folder upload; GitHub Pages requires putting the files in a repository first. Netlify is the simplest for someone who doesn't want to touch Git.

Free HTTPS is automatic on all three. Don't launch without it — browsers flag sites without HTTPS as 'Not secure', which is fatal for a financial services firm.

Part 3 — Switching Off Squarespace (do this in order)

The order matters. Cancelling Squarespace before the DNS move completes will take the site offline and can cost you the domain if it's registered through Squarespace.

Step 1 — Find out where the domain is registered

- 1 Log into Squarespace → **Settings** → **Domains**.
- 2 If northpeakfp.com is listed as a **Squarespace-managed domain**, it was bought through them and must be transferred out or its DNS repointed. If it says **third-party domain**, it lives at another registrar (GoDaddy, Namecheap, etc.) and this is much easier.

Step 2 — Point DNS at the new host

- 1 In the domain's DNS settings, remove the existing A / CNAME records pointing to Squarespace.
- 2 Add the records your new host gave you (Netlify/Cloudflare shows these).
- 3 Save. DNS changes typically take 15 minutes to a few hours; allow up to 48 hours.
- 4 Confirm the new site loads at northpeakfp.com over **https://** and that the padlock shows.

Step 3 — Preserve the old links

The current site has pages at **/about**, **/new-page**, **/new-page-1**, and **/submit**. Anything already indexed by Google will 404 unless redirected. On Netlify, create a file named **_redirects** (no extension) in the site folder containing:

```
/new-page    /about.html  301
/new-page-1  /articles/    301
```

```
/submit      /contact.html 301
/about       /about.html 301
/cart        /services.html 301
```

Step 4 — Only now, cancel Squarespace

- 1 Confirm the new site has been live and working for at least **7 days**.
- 2 Export anything you still need from Squarespace (any form submissions, order history, images).
- 3 If the domain is Squarespace-managed, **transfer the domain out first** to a registrar like Cloudflare or Namecheap. This can take 5–7 days and cannot be rushed.
- 4 Once the domain is safely elsewhere and the site is live, cancel the Squarespace subscription.
- 5 Keep a downloaded backup of the old site content for your records.

Do not skip the 7-day wait. If anything is wrong with DNS, keeping Squarespace active means you can revert instantly. Once cancelled, that safety net is gone.

Part 4 — Background Video for the Hero

The homepage is built to play a looping video behind the headline. It already works without one (an animated gradient and a moving topographic 'peaks' animation show instead), so this is an upgrade, not a requirement.

Where to get royalty-free footage

Source	Cost	Notes
Pexels Videos	Free	No attribution required, commercial use OK. Best overall selection.
Coverr	Free	Purpose-built for website hero backgrounds; short seamless loops.
Mixkit	Free	Curated, high quality, free for commercial use.
Videvo	Free / paid	Check each clip's licence — some require attribution.
Artgrid / Storyblocks	Paid sub	Highest quality if he wants something distinctive.

What to search for (fits the NorthPeak brand)

- **Aerial mountain ridgelines / drone over peaks above clouds** — directly reinforces the 'NorthPeak' name and the climb-to-the-summit metaphor. This is the strongest thematic match.
- **Slow drone push over misty forest or alpine terrain at sunrise** — calm, premium, optimistic.
- **Abstract flowing dark-teal gradients or soft light rays** — safest option; never competes with the text.
- **Time-lapse city skyline at dusk from above** — classic professional-services look, though less distinctive.
- **Slow-moving data visualization / particle network in dark tones** — leans into the 'data-driven' positioning.

Avoid: stock footage of people shaking hands, coins stacking, or literal calculators. They read as generic and slightly dated, and they undercut a premium positioning.

Technical requirements (important for speed)

Setting	Target	Why
Format	MP4 (H.264)	Universal browser support
Resolution	1920x1080	4K is wasted as a background and triples file size
Length	8–15 seconds, seamless loop	Short loops keep the file small
File size	Under 3 MB (ideally ~2 MB)	Video is the #1 cause of slow hero sections

Audio	Removed entirely	It's muted anyway; the audio track is dead weight
Motion	Slow and subtle	Fast motion makes headline text hard to read

Installing it

- 1 Compress the clip first — **HandBrake** (free) or an online tool like FreeConvert. Target 2–3 MB and strip audio.
- 2 Name the file **hero.mp4** and put it in the **assets** folder.
- 3 Export one still frame as **hero-poster.jpg** (also in assets) — it shows instantly while the video loads, so the hero never appears blank.
- 4 That's it. The HTML already references both files.

The video is already set to muted, autoplay, loop, and playsinline, and it is hidden automatically for visitors who have 'reduce motion' enabled in their operating system. A dark overlay sits between the video and the text so the headline stays readable on any footage.